General Ledger

FEATURE GUIDE · ACCOUNTING

This guide covers **General Ledger** and **Trial Balance** — two related but separate screens under Accounting in the sidebar. It continues the Harbor & Vine Catering example used in the Journal Entries, Invoicing, and Billing guides — the entries referenced below are the ones those guides created.

> **What is the General Ledger?**
>
> The General Ledger (GL) is the complete, permanent record of every financial transaction the business has made, organised by account. Every module feeds into it: sending an invoice creates a GL entry, paying a bill creates a GL entry, posting a journal entry creates a GL entry directly. If a number on a report ever looks wrong, the GL is where you trace it back to its source.
>
> **General Ledger** and **Trial Balance** are two different screens:
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> - **General Ledger** — a filterable list of every individual entry.
> - **Trial Balance** — a summary: one row per account, with its total debits, total credits, and net balance for the period.

Browsing the ledger

1. Click **General Ledger** in the sidebar.
2. You'll see every posted entry across every module — Date, Reference, Description, Account, Debit, Credit, and **Module** (which feature created it — Invoice, Bill, Journal Entry, Reconciliation, and so on).

Filter by account

3. Filter by account: select `1400 — Prepaid Insurance`.

> If you followed the Journal Entries guide, you'll see two lines here: a $1,200.00 debit (the initial prepayment) and a $100.00 credit (January's release to expense) — netting to a $1,100.00 balance.

Filter by module

4. Filter by **Module** = `Journal Entry` — only manually-posted entries show, hiding everything invoices and bills generated automatically.
5. Clear the filter, then set **Module** = `Invoice` — only entries created by the Invoicing module appear (the Accounts Receivable / Revenue pairs from the Invoicing guide).

Filter by date and reference

6. Set a date range covering just today. Only entries posted today remain.
7. Search by reference — type an invoice or bill number (e.g. `INV-1001`) to jump straight to the entries that one transaction created.

Export

8. Click **Export CSV** — downloads exactly what's currently filtered, so you can hand a specific account's activity to an accountant without them needing BloomAudit access.

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Trial Balance

> **Why the Trial Balance matters**
> This is the single most important self-check in accounting. Every entry posted anywhere in BloomAudit is double-entry — a debit somewhere is always matched by an equal credit somewhere else. If you add up every account's debits and every account's credits across the whole business, **the two totals must be identical**. If they aren't, there's a data integrity problem that needs to be found before any financial statement can be trusted.

1. Click **Trial Balance** (a separate page from General Ledger, also under Accounting).
2. Pick a period using one of the presets (This Month, This Quarter, This Year, or a custom range).
3. Look at the summary tile at the top: **Balanced** or **Out of Balance**.

> With a healthy set of books, this always reads **Balanced** — total debits exactly equal total credits, down to the cent.

4. Scroll the account list — every account that had any activity in the period is listed with its debit total, credit total, and net balance. Assets and Expenses normally carry debit balances; Liabilities, Equity, and Revenue normally carry credit balances.

Verify it

- [ ] Filtering the General Ledger by `1400 — Prepaid Insurance` shows exactly the entries the Journal Entries guide posted, and the running balance matches what the Chart of Accounts shows for that account.
- [ ] Filtering by **Module = Journal Entry** hides every invoice/bill entry — only manually-created entries remain.
- [ ] **Export CSV** downloads a file containing only the rows currently visible under your active filters, not the whole ledger.
- [ ] **Trial Balance** for the current period reads **Balanced**, and the grand total of the Debit column equals the grand total of the Credit column exactly.
- [ ] If you reversed an entry in the Journal Entries guide, the reversed pair (original + reversal) still nets to zero in the Trial Balance — confirming the reversal didn't leave a stray imbalance behind.

Permissions used in this guide: `chart_of_accounts:read` (covers both the General Ledger entries list and Trial Balance — both are read-only screens, no create/edit permissions apply here).

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